

1938, July 18

The following is a faithful transcription of the type written original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

did the whole place up and down, without finding any indication of where one might find a lunch. It was good that we were not very hungry, otherwise it would probably have been a story of "sour grapes". There was one, quite a BEER sign but we hardly appreciated such an invitation. In about ten minutes we were back on the highway, now bent on seeing the old farm and once familiar hills and valleys, etc.

As a child I had never seen Diamond Bluff, but I had pictured it as quite a town at the mouth of the beautiful Trimbelle. I knew it had a store or two and that the Smith childrens' father had started another one, and that the steamboats used to stop there, but today's visit was to me rather a disappointment. We had gone perhaps eighty rods when we came to a road leading up to the left, which must have been the southern end of what we once upon a time called "the Main Road:. Here Good Providence would have us meet another Raphael. It was a handsome, rustic youth, driving some milch cows--a happy sight in itself. We stopped beside him. "Where is the mouth of the Trimbelle" I asked. Pointing down the river to one of the many beautiful cliffs, he answered: "It's just behind yonder mountain-head, two miles further on your way." "God bless you, Boy" and on we sped. Then I remembered what had struck me as a sort of mystery passing down that way 25 years before. I had taken quite a risk, as some of my friends thought, when, coming back from the Golden Jubilee, in Seattle. I got off at St. Paul, determined to say Holy Mass, even if the only train for Chicago that day, besides "our own" was due in 30 minutes, and I wanted to make Detroit next morning (Saturday). It had been raining ever since we left Seattle, (Tuesday evening), snowing, however, while crossing some of the Rocky Mountains: and now swirling clouds were actually twisting around the "Twin Cities" skyscrapers. The Union Depot in St. Paul had been burned to the ground the day before yesterday, and, as yet, order and confusion were still wrangling for mastery. Your above referred to barefoot boy-friend--now Sergeant Costello--was on the scene, and gave me a warm greeting, mutually brief, however, for he was busy and I was in a hurry. He was prepared for the threatened storm and, as yet, I was able to dodge the drops or ignore them.

HOLY MASS OFFERED--TWO TRAINS HELD--THANKS BE TO GOD

Under such circumstances, I surely did hesitate: briefly, however, for there was really no time for deliberation. Having no umbrella, I started back to our train about to start off. then, again, seeing that it was not actually raining to speak